AVL / Literary Theory: annotations

Literary Theory (20th – 21st centuries): Critical Perspective, Historical Experience, Political Regime.

niemand sollte umsonst arbeiten

Date: 2026-11-07
class: [16418] Literary Theory :: tutor: kalinin :: term: WS26 snc: 17432.1
snc: 16132. ɪʃɔ : ʁ wer es [ρελεχιλ] ausspricht, und nicht [ρεʁεχιλ]

notes on papers

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[1] "Tynianov. On literary evolution.pdf"
[2] "Screen_12_4_Documents_from_LEF_and_Novy_LEF.pdf"
[3] "Shklovski - Theory of Prose.pdf"
[4] "vibranye.pdf"
[5] "shklovsky, art as device (berliner).pdf"
[6] "shklovsky-viktor-the-resurrection-of-the-word.pdf"
[7] "Coiled_Verbal_Spring_Devices_of_Lenins_Language_2018.pdf"

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docs annotated:

[1] "Coiled_Verbal_Spring_Devices_of_Lenins_Language_2018.pdf"
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[6] "Tynianov. On literary evolution.pdf"
[7] "vibranye.pdf"
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(7) annotations: Coiled_Verbal_Spring_Devices_of_Lenins_Language_2018.pdf

paper: Boynik (2018)

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5

OUT OF SYNCH WITH THE THING

5

NA

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149

Viktor Shklovsky LENIN AS DECANONISER

149

A renaming can be separative. It happens when a previously single phenomenon disintegrates into two or more parts, for example, the Bolsheviks and the Mensheviks

149

A separative renaming is thus a means of separating a concept from an old word that no longer corresponds to it.

150

With a single renaming, we should keep in mind that one word has been displaced by another. This aspect and it alone is agitational. The renaming is most palpable in the aspect of displacement.

150

Leningrad's street names were a sign of change in 1919. Now they are means of notation

(33) annotations: Screen_12_4_Documents_from_LEF_and_Novy_LEF.pdf

paper: Sherwood (1971)

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1

The Academy and Pushkin are less comprehensible than hieroglyphs. Throw Pushkin, Dostoevsky, Tolstoy, etc, etc, from the steamer of modernity

1

Futurists' Paper No. 1 from the ' Poets' Cafe '. It continued the attacks on old art, and demanded the separation of art from the state

1

The Futurists were the only art group to cooperate wholeheartedly with the new regime

1

Documents from Lef

2

The man-made object became a cult - the physical presence of material things, whether made by artists or factory workers, was held to more valuable than any 'idea' behind them.

2

proletarian art was not ' art for the proletariat', or ' art of the proletariat', but' art created by an artist with talent and a proletariat consciousness

2

Narkompros

3

I also am a factory

3

Artists must become producers. We must think less about beauty and create real things *

platonov, baugrube essai, link: https://ada-sub.dh-index.org/school/essais/10277_platonov/
platonov: ~1926f

3

Art of the Commune

all these were distasteful to the proletariat, to the old bourgeoisie, and to the party leaders, including Lenin, whose tastes in art were generally very conservative.

3

March 1919

3

Dmitriev

Craft - the manufacture of furniture, utensils, signs, clothes - as basic creation in life, is becoming the foundation for new inspiration, is becoming the basis and meaning of art

March 1919

3

Dmitriev

NA

March 1919

4

aesthetics does not lead life but trails along in its wake

5

Lef stands for * Left Front of the Arts

6

linguist Formalist Grigorii Vinokur, giving several studies of Futurists and language

7

left artist' could only be defined roughly as an artist influenced by Futurist, Formalist or Constructivist theories on art, ie a general hostility to imitation of life, in favour of ' creation' or ' construction * of life

8

Literature of Fact

Art genres now considered most worthy were those comprising ' factography', ie the newspaper report, the diary, the travelsketch, the documentary film,

18

The So-Called ’ Formal Method’ Lef, Vol I pp 213-5

19

Everything that a poet writes is i 43 meaningful as a part of his general work, and is totally worthless j as an expression of his ’ I’.

19

Poets do not invent themes, they take them from their surrounding millieu. The work of the poet starts with the processing of the theme, with finding a corresponding linguistic form for it

descriptive or prescriptive? demand or observation?

20

Opoyaz’ will show them that everything great has been created in answer to questions of the day, that the * eternal’ today was then a topic of the time, and that the great poet does not reveal himself, but simply carries out the social command

21

Constructivism is a set of systematised ideas and social attitudes of mind which emphatically reflect the organisational impact of a working class

21

simple mastery of literacy

21

Constructivism is acquiring a wide social and cultural significance, as a result of the need to cover, in a relatively short time, the space which separates the proletariat, as a culturally backward class, from high-level present-day techniques

22

Constructivists consider it essential in their poetic work to reflect revolutionary contemporaneity, both thematically, and in relation to its technical needs

35

Left Front of the Arts (Lef) should, in’ 1927-8, proclaim ’ factography’ as the correct task of the revolutionary artist

35

Opoyaz (The Society for the Study of Poetic Language

35

Documents from Novy Lef

36

before 1917, there had been no Marxist aesthetics as such.

38

In Germany, the Communist Party helped organise a German equivalent of RAPP, the Bund Proletarisch-revolutionarer Schriftsteller (League of Proletarian Revolutionary Writers) with its organ Die Linkskurve.

39

literature of fact

that the art which had concentrated its revolution on the means of artistic production, expanding poetic language into trans-sense language, transforming poetic devices such as metaphor, had led both to a change in the content from traditional literary material to such extra-literary uses of language as letters, memoirs, diaries, newspapers and feuilletons

43

While major poetic forms such as, for instance, the narrative poem, may still be the subject of controversy within Lef from the standpoint of their functional expediency, there is no controversy over such forms as the feuilleton, the slogan and the pragmatically orientated agit-poem.

(9) annotations: Shklovski - Theory of Prose.pdf

paper: Šklovskij (1991)

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205

A literary work is pure form. It is neither thing nor material, but a relationship of materials

205

Literature without a Plot: Rozanov

205

NA

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206

The old forms, no more consciously felt than grammatical forms are in speech, have lost their artistic character to assume an official status that precludes sensation

206

my formula to the effect that the “content” (the soul is meant here) of a literary work is equal to the sum of its stylistic devices

206

But I shall endeavor to prove that the soul of a literary work is none other than its structure or form

207

The choice of material for a work of art is also accomplished along formal lines

207

It is possible to renew a cliche by emphasizing its conventionality

208

So, for example, the speeches of Don Quixote permit Cervantes to introduce into the novel a variety of critical and philosophical materials.

(13) annotations: shklovsky-viktor-the-resurrection-of-the-word.pdf

paper: Šklovskij (1914)

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2

not ‘recognise’ the familiar word.

2

This loss of the form of the word represents a great easement for the thought-processes and may be a necessary condition for the existence of science, but art could never be satisfied with this eroded word

3

Here the decoration is not made, it is ‘narrated’ and relies on people not seeing it, but on their recognising it and saying - ‘it’s the same’.

3

if we sense the nobility and humanity of the thoughts of the most humane poets in the world, then these sensations have nothing in common with art

4

NA

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4

resurrect things

we pave ceased to be artists in everyday life, we do not love our houses and clothes, and easily part from a life of which we are not aware. Only the creation of new forms of art can restore to man sensation of the world, can resurrect things and kill pessimism.

“ ” not only internal artistic but also external dimension

4

The ‘arbitrary’ and ‘derived’ words of the Futurists have been born.

4

poetic devices are the devices of general linguistic thoughtprocesses, simply introduced by them into poetry

4

but we have become too used to setting up comprehensibility as a necessary requirement of poetic language.

4

this sort of semi-comprehensible language seems to the reader, by reason of its unfamiliarity, more figurative

4

Futuristy) poets are on the right path: they have correctly evaluated the old forms.

4

split it up by rhyme, like Mayakovsky

4

reminiscent of that polished surface of which Korolenko spoke: 'across it runs the plane of thought, touching nothing.

(19) annotations: shklovsky, art as device (berliner).pdf

paper: Šklovskij (2015)

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2

appeared in an earlier issue of Poetika in 1917

2

these terms are associated with Bertolt Brecht's Verfremdung and interpersonal estrangement (as in "she is estranged from her family"). These two concepts suggest decreased emotional connection to people, fictional or real, which is the opposite of the intended effect of ostranenie

8

an enormous sphere of art turned out not to be a method of thinking; one of the arts constituting this sphere, lyrical poetry, is nevertheless very similar to "image-bearing" art: it uses words in the same way; most importantly, image-bearing art flows into imageless art quite imperceptibly, and we experience the two in similar ways.

8

art is, above all, the creator of symbols"

8

images turn out to be almost immobile; they flow, unchanging, from century to century, from country to country, from poet to poet

8

The better you comprehend an epoch, the better can you see that the images you believed to be created by a particular poet are actually borrowed from others and almost unchanged

8

Images are a given, and poetry is not so much thinking in images as remembering them.

8

“art is thinking in images

9

Russian eighteenth-century poets place adjectives after nouns

9

suggests that a given work depends in its artistry— in whether or not it is poetry— on our perception

10

like saying: head ¼ sphere, watermelon ¼ sphere. This is thinking, but it has nothing in common with poetry.

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10

Spencer’s footsteps: “The merit of style consists precisely in delivering the greatest amount of thoughts in the fewest words.”

11

Regarding economy as a law and goal of creation might

22Yakubinsky’s article, which states that the law of liquid consonant dissimilation is missing from poetic language and that in poetic language such hard-to-pronounce sound combinations are possible, is one of the first scientifically sound indications of the opposition (in this case, at least) between poetic language and practical language

11

. It is the automatization process which explains the laws of our prosaic speech, its under-structured phrases and its half-pronounced words. This process is ideally expressed in algebra, which replaces things with symbols. In quick practical speech, words are not spoken fully; only their initial sounds are registered by the mind

12

the device of art

And so this thing we call art exists in order to restore the sensation of life, in order to make us feel things, in order to make a stone stony.

12

. Algebraizing, automatizing a thing, we save the greatest amount of perceptual effort: things are either given as a single feature, for instance, a number, or else they follow a formula of sorts without ever reaching consciousness

12

The goal of art is to create the sensation of seeing, and not merely recognizing, things; the device of art is the “enstrangement” of things and the complication of the form, which increases the duration and complexity of perception

13

Tolstoy’s method of estrangement consists in not calling a thing or event by its name but describing it as if seen for the first time, as if happening for the first time

21

46The language of poetry is difficult, laborious language which puts the brakes on perception

(17) annotations: Tynianov. On literary evolution.pdf

paper: Tynianov et al. (2019)

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2

actively developing literature. The latter’s representatives readily accept literary history for its establishment of various traditional norms and laws, and tend to mix up the “historicity” of a literary phenomenon with “historicism” in relation to it

3

two main types, based on their points of observation: the study of the genesis of literary phenomena, and the study of the evolution of literary series, that is, of literary changeability

3

studying individual works and the laws of their construction in extra-historical terms (the abolishment of literary history)

3

the values of one cultural-historical system are used in evaluating another

5

the lexicon of a given work is immediately interrelated with the literary lexicon and the general lexicon of everyday speech, as well as with other elements of the work

5

unmarked, non-archaic “musical” [muzykal’nyi]

10

The variability of the functions of a given formal element; the emergence of a function in a formal element; the formal element’s attachment to a function—these are all important questions of literary evolution

11

The literary function evolves from one historical period to another, while the functions of the entire literary series relative to its many neighboring series evolve over centuries

11

We currently see the novel as interrelated with “the novel” according to its size, or the way the plot is developed, while at one time it was defined according to the presence of a love story

12

free verse emphasized the poetic principle through extra-metrical characteristics, and Sterne’s novel emphasized the plot principle through characteristics external to the fabula

12

These interrelations of a literary series with the everyday series take place through speech; literature’s function in relation to everyday life is a speech function

13

In Karamzin’s time, the ultimate real-life series for these speech phenomena was the salon. Otherwise a fact of everyday life, during this period the salon became a literary fact. This is an example of how everyday forms get attached to the literary function

14

Heine’s “literary personality” was likewise quite removed from the biographical, authentic Heine.

16

If we agree that evolution is a change in the interrelations of a system’s parts—i.e., a change in its functions and formal elements—it follows that evolution is a “shift” of systems.

16

however, they do presume a new function for these formal elements

16

There are influences that modify and deform literature without being evolutionarily significant

17

evolutionary interaction of forms and functions

(3) annotations: vibranye.pdf

paper: Mayakovsky (1949)

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2

ВИБРАНЕ

3

ВІЙНУ ОГОЛОШЕНО

NA

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3

ВІЙНУ ОГОЛОШЕНО

Кав'ярня, скривавивши морду', свище і звіром реве за дверима: «Отруїмо кров'ю Рейнське грище! Громами ядер на мармур Рима!» З неба, подертого об багнетні жала, сіялись зорі, як зерно у решеті. І стоптана чоботом жалість скавчала: «Ах, пустіте, пустіте! Брешете!»

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